whether the statistic is correct. As I said previously, not all criticism of Israel is antisemitism, and you mostly recognize antisemitism by a tone (or an undertone) of sheer hatred.

Wednesday, May 17

Ben-Gvir again boycotts voting (because of insufficient budget allocations for the Negev and the Galilee) and thus allowed a law introduced by the opposition to pass. Netanyahu says he will solve the problem. In a meeting of Jewish Power, Ben-Gvir has also criticized his ally—up to now, Smotrich—as a result of the impossibility of finding additional amounts for the evil clown's demands. As for the ultra-Orthodox, they continue to demand their 627 million shekels. In short, the budget debate has become an unseemly circus.

Tomorrow, the provocative flags march will take place in Jerusalem. The police are on high alert. Hamas is threatening. The evil clown will take part.

Thursday, May 18

The march of thousands in Jerusalem took place without major incidents, but showed once more the ugliest face of Israeli nationalism and racism: you should have heard the anti-Arab insults and the attempts at violence (stopped by a massive police presence) while hundreds of Jewish youngsters marched through Arab quarters of Jerusalem. Ben-Gvir was there and it is his party that was essentially represented among the most vociferous and most violent.

The budget circus goes on without anybody giving in, but Netanyahu seems confident that it will get through on the legally required date of May 29. The governor of the Bank of Israel announced that next week the interest rate will go up again because of the persistent inflation.